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How To Create GUI Dialog Boxes In Bash Scripts With Whiptail In Linux

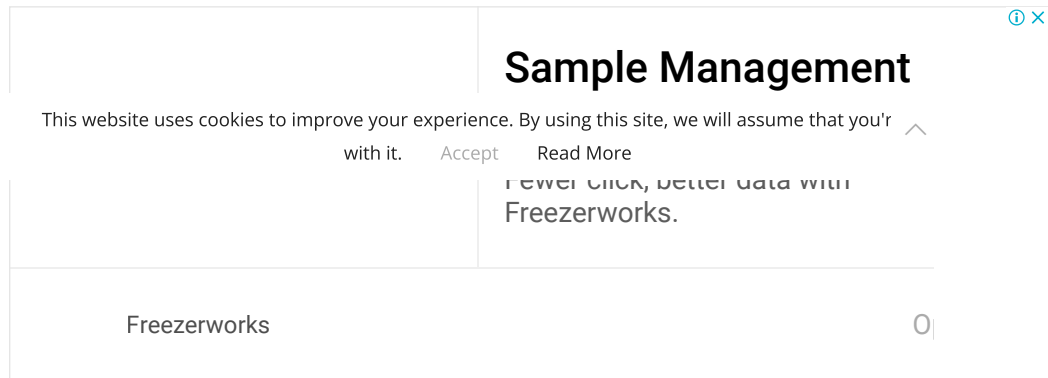
Written by Karthick | **Published:** February 23, 2022 | **Last Updated on** February 9, 2023 | 14201 views

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A while ago, we briefly discussed about [Zenity](#), a simple program that allows you to create graphical (GTK+) dialog boxes in command-line and shell scripts. In this article, we are going to discuss yet another GUI utility called **Whiptail** that can be used to **create GUI dialog boxes in Bash scripts in Linux**.

Not every script that you write needs a frontend graphical interface. But sometimes it would be better if you create a graphical interface instead of relying on interacting with the command line. In my case, if there is a long list of responses needed in the script I would choose to go with a graphical interface.



Whiptail is a friendly GUI utility that uses a [newt](#) programming library. Whiptail offers different dialog boxes for different purposes. Depending upon your use case you can use these dialog boxes to make your script more interactive.

Install Whiptail in Linux

Whiptail comes pre-installed with many distributions but if your distribution has no whiptail installed follow the below instructions to install it.

To check if whiptail is already installed run the following command.

```
$ which whiptail
```

To install Whiptail on Debian/Ubuntu and its derivative distributions, run the following command:

```
$ sudo apt install whiptail -y
```

Fedora/RHEL/CnetOS/AlmaLinux/Rocky Linux:

```
$ sudo dnf install newt
```

Arch Linux, EndeavourOS, Manjaro Linux:

```
$ sudo pacman -S whiptail
```

Alpine Linux:

```
$ apk add whiptail
```

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Help Option

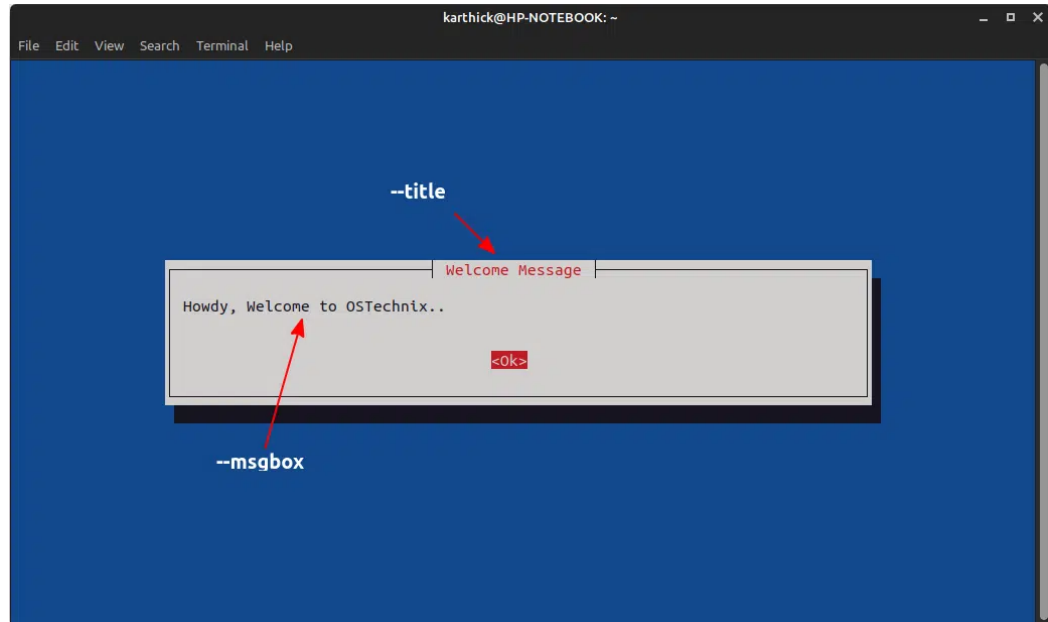
You can use `--help` flag which will display the list of supported dialog boxes and other options you can use. In total, there are 10 dialog box supported with various functionality and we will look at them about all in the upcoming sections.

```
$ whiptail -help
Box options:
--msgbox <text> <height> <width>
--yesno  <text> <height> <width>
--infobox <text> <height> <width>
--inputbox <text> <height> <width> [init]
--passwordbox <text> <height> <width> [init]
--textbox <file> <height> <width>
--menu <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item] ...
--checklist <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item status]...
--radiolist <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item status]...
--gauge <text> <height> <width> <percent>
```

1. Message Box

Message box will display messages to the user and wait till the user presses <ok> or <ESC> key. When you press <ok> it will throw a **return code 0** and if you press <ESC> it will throw **return code 255**.

```
$ whiptail --title "Welcome Message" --msgbox "Howdy, Welcome to OSTechNix.." 8 78
```



Message Box

Let's decode the above command.

--title	This will add title to the window
--msgbox	This will print the message you provide within the quotes.
8 78	This set Height(8) and Width(78) of the window.

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s waiting

for you to press <ok> or <ESC>.

```
$ ps -ef | grep -i whiptail
karthick  20023    9251  0 22:41 pts/0    00:00:00 whiptail --title Welcome Me
karthick  20071    19379  0 22:41 pts/1    00:00:00 grep --color=auto -i whiptail
```

```
$ ps -q 20023 -o state --no-headers
S
```

NOTE: State (S) -> interruptible sleep (waiting for an event to complete).

2. Info Box

Info is similar to the message box but the difference is unlike the message box info box will not wait for the user input. Use --infobox flag and pass a string as an argument which will be displayed in the info box.

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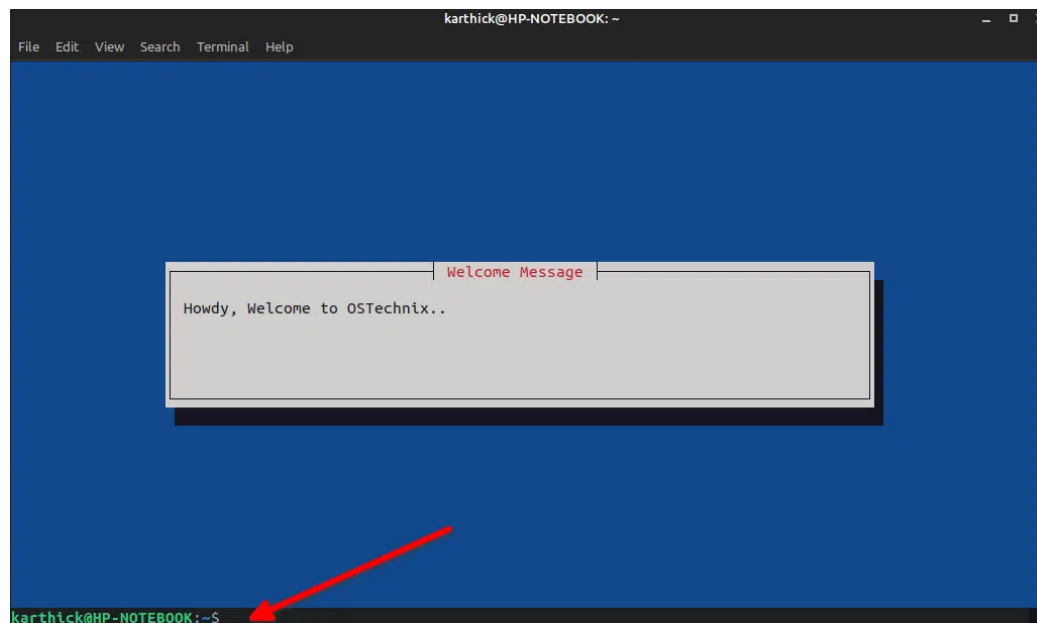
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In some shells, info box will run but will not display any result. You have to change the terminal emulation and run it as I did in the below snippet.

```
$ TERM=ansi whiptail --title "Welcome Message" --infobox "Howdy, Welcome to OST
```



Info Box

3. Yes/No Box

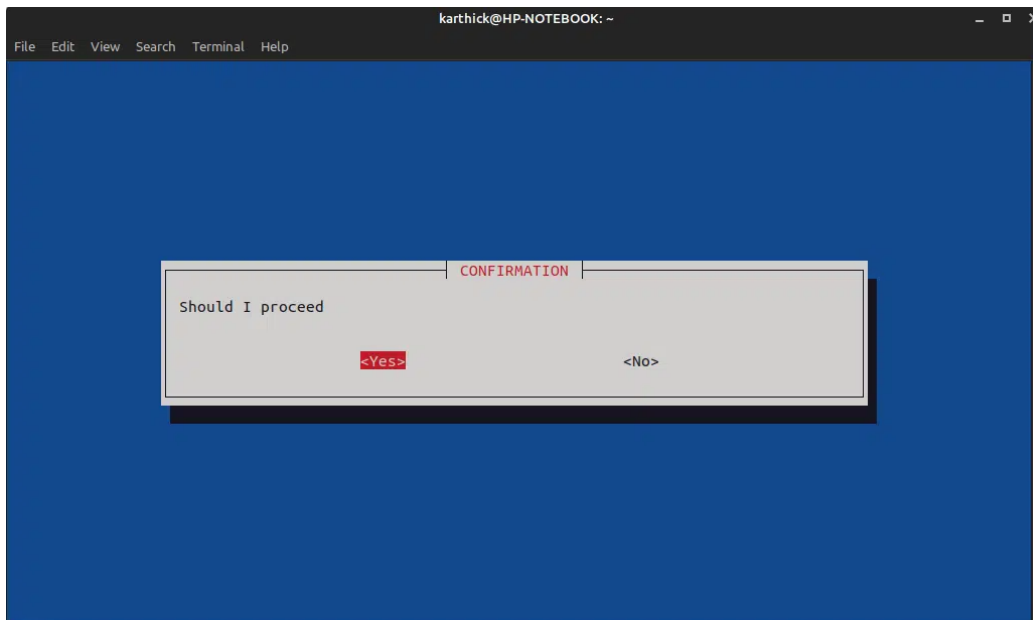
Yes/No Box will display a dialog box with **YES** or **NO** option where if you choose **<Yes>** it will throw **return code 0** and when you press **<No>** it will throw **return code 1**.

Use **--yesno** flag to prompt for the choice. Run the following snippet which combines the yes/no box and the message box. At first, it will display the Yes/No option, and depending upon your choice it will throw the return code.

Create a shell script, copy the below snippet, and run it.

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```
whiptail --title "CONFIRMATION" --yesno "Should I proceed" 8 78
if [[ $? -eq 0 ]]; then
    whiptail --title "MESSAGE" --msgbox "Process completed successfully." 8 78
elif [[ $? -eq 1 ]]; then
    whiptail --title "MESSAGE" --msgbox "Cancelling Process since user pressed <N
elif [[ $? -eq 255 ]]; then
    whiptail --title "MESSAGE" --msgbox "User pressed ESC. Exiting the script" 8
fi
```



Yes/No Dialog Box

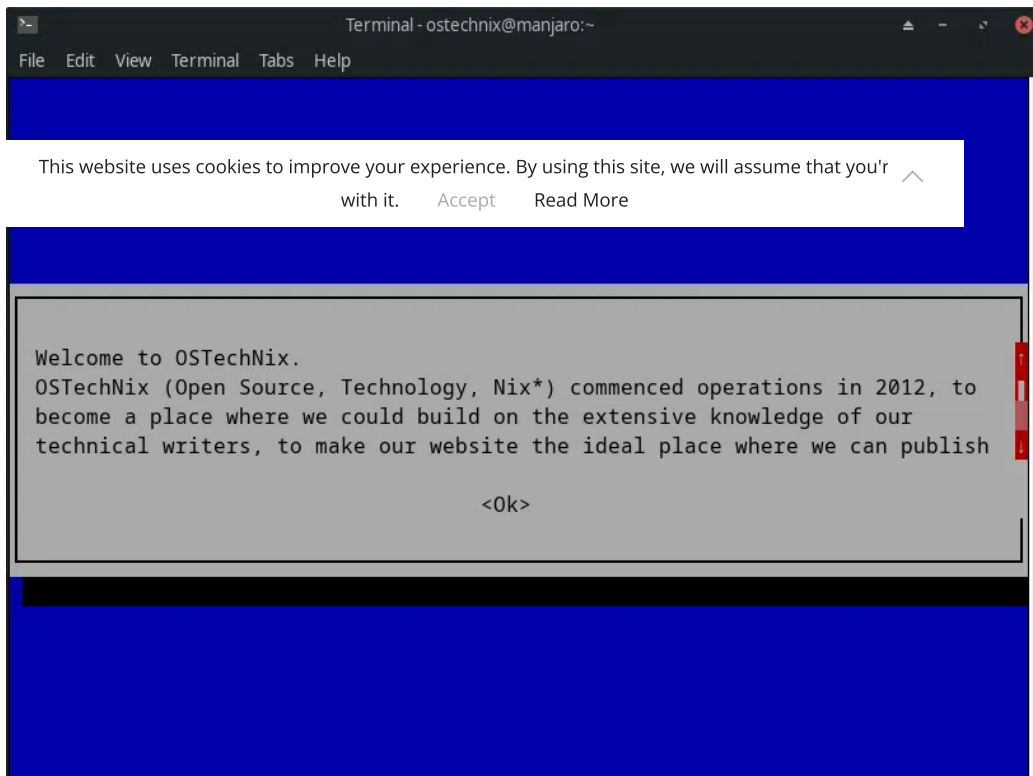
If you have no idea about bash conditional statements, take a look at our brief article on the same using the link below.

- [Bash Scripting – Conditional Statements](#)

4. Text Box

Text box will read and print the file. In the below snippet I am reading the `ostechnix.txt` file. The flag `--scrolltext` allows you to use the mouse wheel to scroll vertically when you have long pages of text that do not fit into the current window.

```
$ whiptail --textbox --scrolltext ostechnix.txt 10 80
```



Text Box

5. Redirections

The dialog boxes that you are going to see in the upcoming section require output to be stored in a variable and later use for processing. The return value from the widget is sent to stderr instead of stdout. So you have to swap stdout and stderr so that the result is stored in the variable.

You have to use the following expression to swap stdout and stderr.

```
3>&1 1>&2 2>&3
```

Let's try to understand the above expression. You know FD1 is the standard output and FD2 is the standard error.

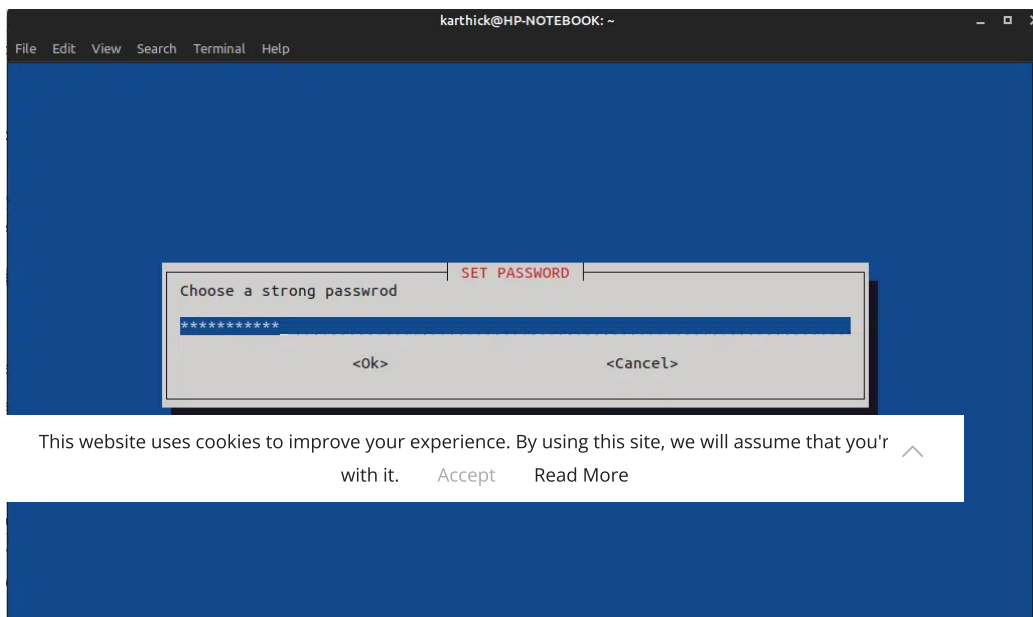
- **3>&1** - Anything that is redirected to file descriptor 3 is redirected to file descriptor 1.
- **1>&2** - Anything that is sent to file descriptor 1(Stdout) is redirected to file descriptor 2.
- **2>&3** - Anything that is sent to file descriptor 2(stderr) is redirected to file descriptor 3.

This way we are swapping stdout and stderr so the variable can store the return value from dialog boxes.

6. Password Box

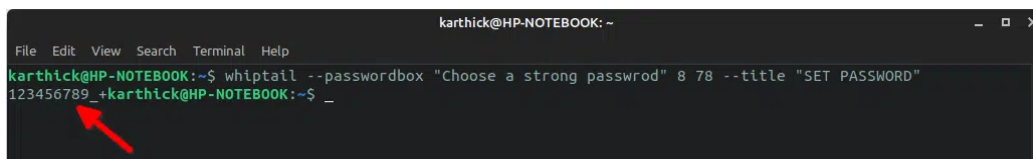
Using the password dialog box you can type passwords that will not be displayed as plain text as you type. Use `--passwordbox` to prompt to enter the password.

```
$ whiptail --title "SET PASSWORD" --passwordbox "Choose a strong password"
```



Password DialogBox

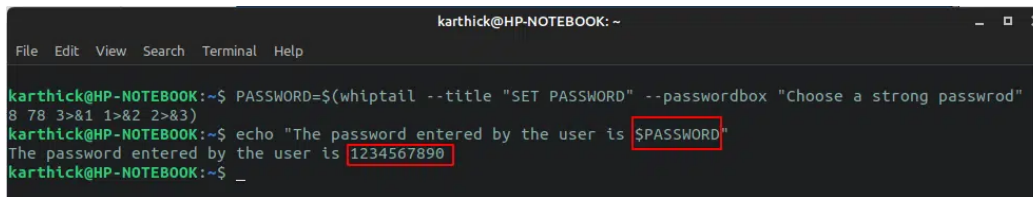
When you press **<ok>**, it will throw the return code 0 and will return the password you typed to the console (stderr) if you are running from the terminal.



Output In Terminal

You need to capture the password into a variable then later use it in the script. As discussed in the Redirection section you have to redirect the result.

```
$ PASSWORD=$(whiptail --title "SET PASSWORD" --passwordbox "Choose a strong password" 8 78 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
$ echo "The password entered by the user is $PASSWORD"
```



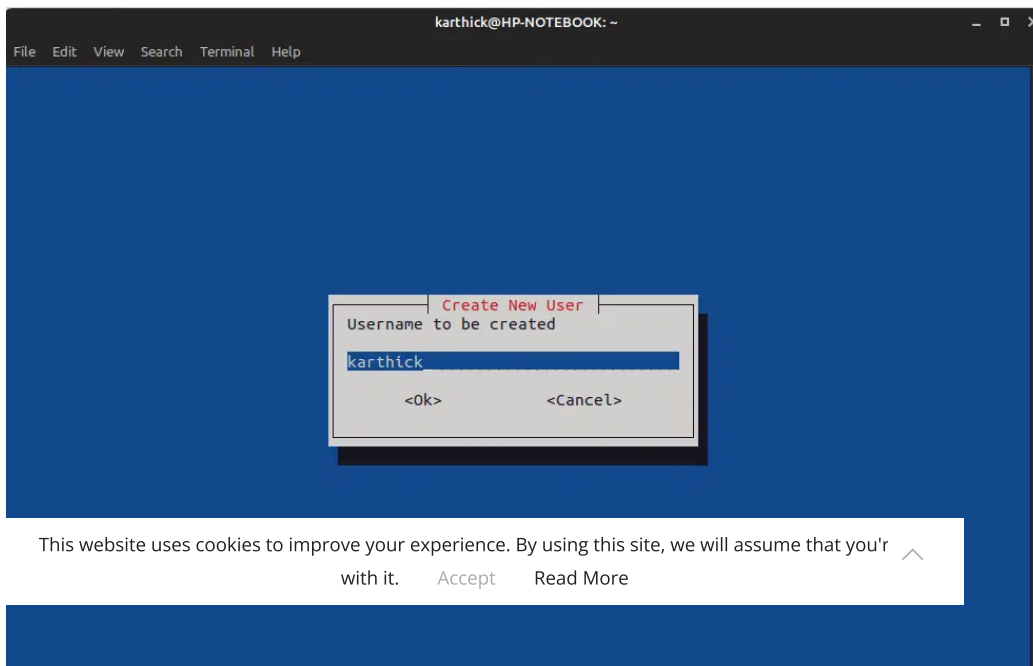
```
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK: ~
File Edit View Search Terminal Help
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ PASSWORD=$(whiptail --title "SET PASSWORD" --passwordbox "Choose a strong password" 8 78 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ echo "The password entered by the user is $PASSWORD"
The password entered by the user is 1234567890
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ _
```

Store Output In Variable

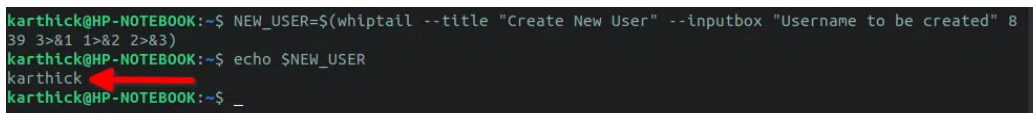
7. Input Box

Input dialog box will prompt the user to provide the input. As with the password dialog box, the input given by you will be printed to the terminal if you are running it from the terminal. You have to use the redirections and store the value to a variable then later use for processing according to your program logic.

```
NEW_USER=$(whiptail --title "Create New User" --inputbox "Username to be created" 8 78 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
```



Input Box



```
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ NEW_USER=$(whiptail --title "Create New User" --inputbox "Username to be created" 8 78 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ echo $NEW_USER
karthick
karthick@HP-NOTEBOOK:~$ _
```

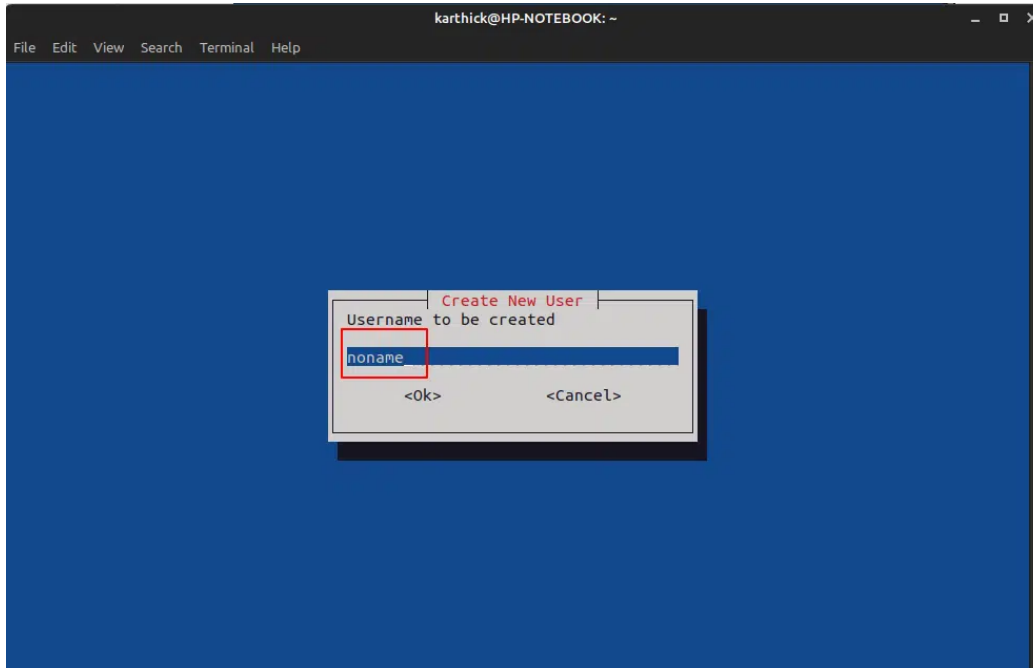
Store Output To Variable

You can also set default input text. All you have to do is add the text after height and width. Below is the syntax where instead of [init] you will place the default text.

```
--inputbox <text> <height> <width> [init]
```

Example:

```
whiptail --title "Create New User" --inputbox "Username to be created" 8 40 nor
```



Default Text

Now let's combine the input box, password box, Yes/No Box and Text Box and write a simple user creation program to see how these dialog boxes can be coupled together.

8. Checklist Dialog Box

Checklist allows you to create a list of options that a user can select from.

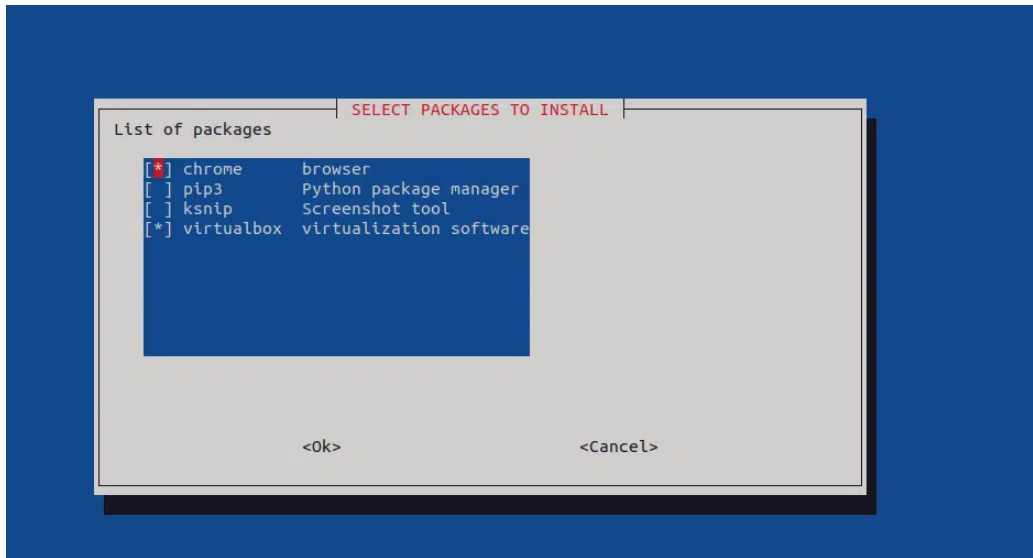
```
--checklist <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item status]...
```

Above is the syntax for creating a checklist dialog box. You have to use the `--checklist` flag followed by setting up the height and width of the dialog box.

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```
$ whiptail --title "SELECT PACKAGES TO INSTALL" --checklist \
"List of packages" 20 100 10 \
"chrome" "browser" OFF \
"pip3" "Python package manager" OFF \
"ksnip" "Screenshot tool" OFF \
"virtualbox" "virtualization software" ON
```

To select a list press space bar and use up and down arrows to move between the list. Once done press enter.



CheckList Dialog Box

You can store the output to an array and later use it. The tag ("Chrome, pip3, ksnip, virtualbox") names will be printed as output to stderr based on the selection.

```
SELECTED=$(whiptail --title "SELECT PACKAGES TO INSTALL" --checklist \
  "List of packages" 20 100 10 \
  "chrome" "browser" OFF \
  "pip3" "Python package manager" OFF \
  "ksnip" "Screenshot tool" OFF \
  "virtualbox" "virtualization software" ON 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3))
```

```
$ echo ${SELECTED[@]} # Array of values
```

Sample output:

```
"pip3" "ksnip" "virtualbox"
```

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look at

the link below.

- [Bash Scripting - Indexed Array Explained With Examples](#)

9. Radio List Dialog Box

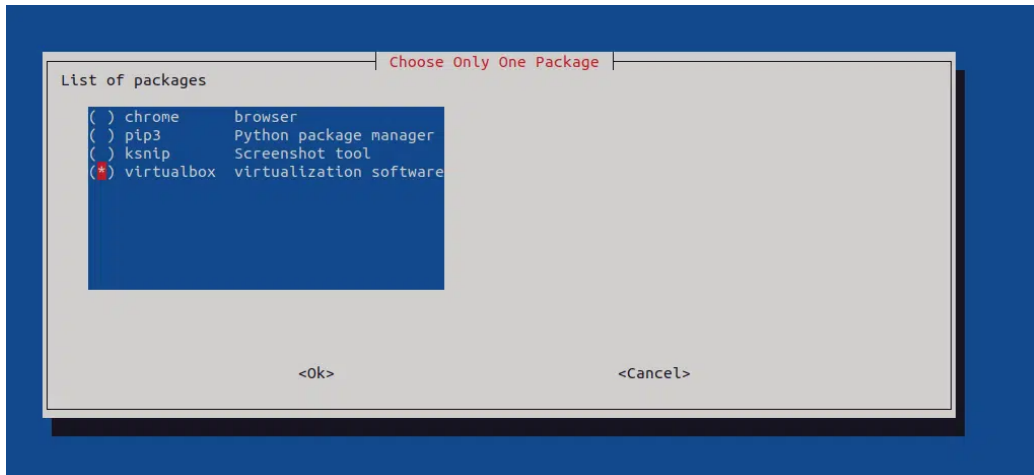
Radio list dialog box is similar to the checklist dialog box but the only difference is you can only choose one option from the list. Syntactically both the radio list and checklist are the same.

```
--radiolist <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item status]...
```

Example:

```
SELECTED=$(whiptail --title "Choose Only One Package" --radiolist \
  "List of packages" 20 100 10 \
  "chrome" "browser" OFF \
  "pip3" "Python package manager" OFF \
```

```
"ksnip" "Screenshot tool" OFF \
"virtualbox" "virtualization software" OFF 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
```



Radio Button

```
$ echo $SELECTED
virtualbox
```

10. Menu Dialog Box

Menu dialog box is similar to the radio button dialog box. The only difference I feel is, in the radio button dialog box you have to press <space-bar> to select an item from the list then press enter. But in the menu dialog box, all you have to do is just press enter which will return the tag name to stderr.

The syntax is similar to the checklist and radio button but the only difference is there is no need for the "status" option to set ON/OFF in the menu dialog box.

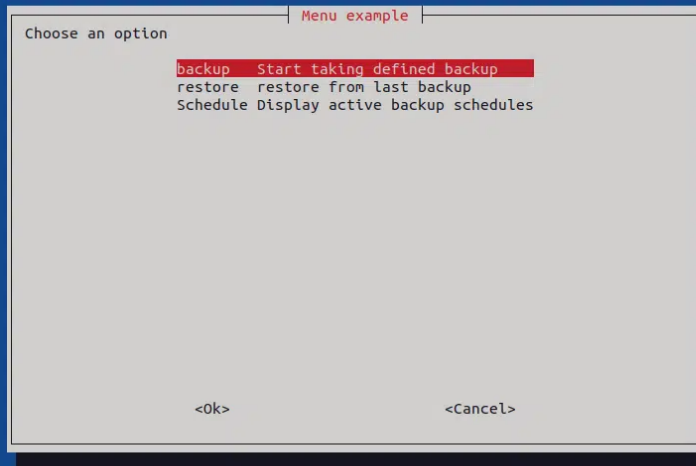
```
--menu <text> <height> <width> <listheight> [tag item]
```

Example:

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5 \

```
"backup" "Start taking defined backup" \
"restore" "restore from last backup" \
"Schedule" "Display active backup schedules" 3>&1 1>&2 2>&3)
```



Menu Dialog Box

```
$ echo $TO_RUN
backup
```

11. Progress Bar

To create a progress bar you have to use the following syntax. First, you will pass a text which will be printed when the progress bar is running and set the height and width of the window followed by the percentage of the progress.

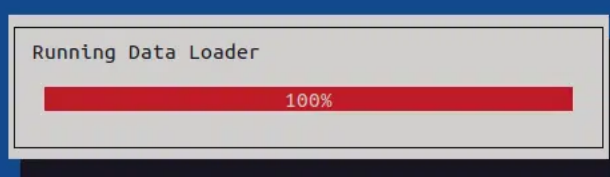
```
--gauge <text> <height> <width> <percent>
```

The progress percentage will be controlled by our logic. Take a look at the below snippet. I am redirecting the while loop to the progress bar and incrementing the COUNTER variable in 10 counts which will be used as the percentage of progress.

```
#!/usr/bin/env bash
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while [[ ${COUNTER} -le 100 ]]; do
    sleep 1
    COUNTER=$((COUNTER+10))
    echo ${COUNTER}
done | whiptail --gauge "Running Data Loader" 6 50 ${COUNTER}
```

The progress bar will increment in the count of 10's.



Conclusion

We have reached the end of this article. Here, we have briefly seen **how to use Whiptail to create various dialog boxes in bash scripts**. If you have already used whiptail and have any trick under the sleeve, share it with us through the comment box.

Resource:

- [Whiptail](#)

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- [How To Use Date Command In Bash Scripting In Linux](#)
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- [Bash Scripting – Parse Arguments In Bash Scripts Using getopt](#)
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KARTHICK

Karthick is a passionate software engineer who loves to explore new technologies. He is a public speaker and loves writing about technology especially about Linux and opensource.



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How To Deploy Kubernetes Cluster On AWS With Amazon EKS

Creating a Kubernetes Cluster with Elastic Kubernetes Service

Written by M.S.M. Sivam | **Published:** February 21, 2022 | **Last Updated on** February 9, 2023 | 1.4K views

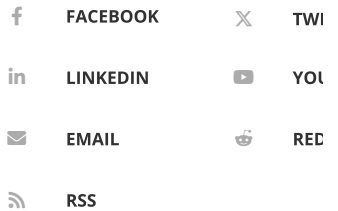
SEARCH

Type and hit enter...

In this article, we are going to learn about how to **deploy a Kubernetes Cluster on AWS with Amazon EKS** and how to **install and configure AWS CLI and Kubectl** to interact with the EKS cluster from commandline in Linux.

Before deploying Kubernetes cluster on AWS cloud using Amazon Elastic Kubernetes Service, make sure you have an AWS account. If you don't have an AWS account, check our [Introduction to Amazon Web Services \(AWS\)](#) article to know how to create one.

KEEP IN TOUCH



1. Setup EKS Cluster (Master Node)

To create an EKS cluster in AWS, you need to have an IAM role created in hand.

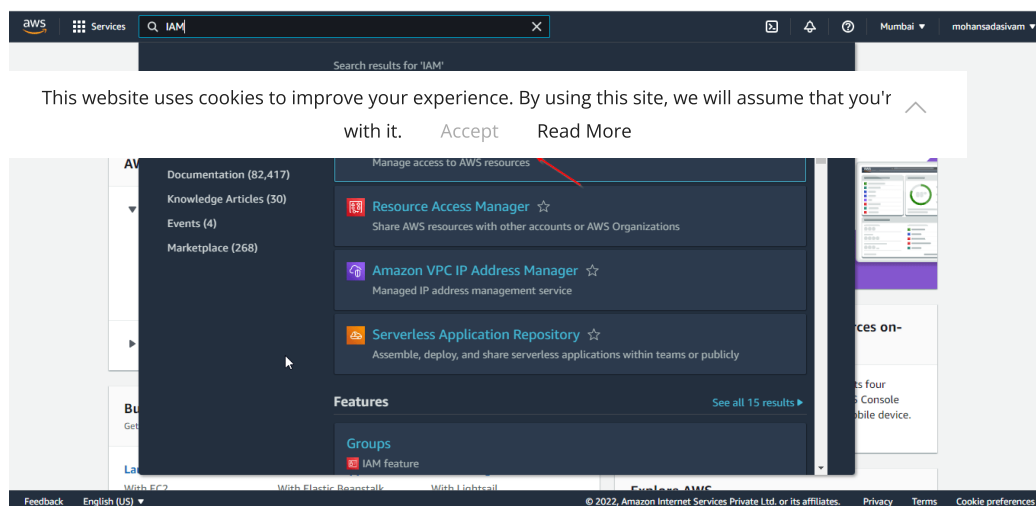
1.1. Create IAM role

Amazon EKS-managed Kubernetes clusters make calls on your behalf to other AWS services to manage the resources you utilize with the service.

You must first create an IAM role with the following IAM policy before you may construct Amazon EKS clusters:

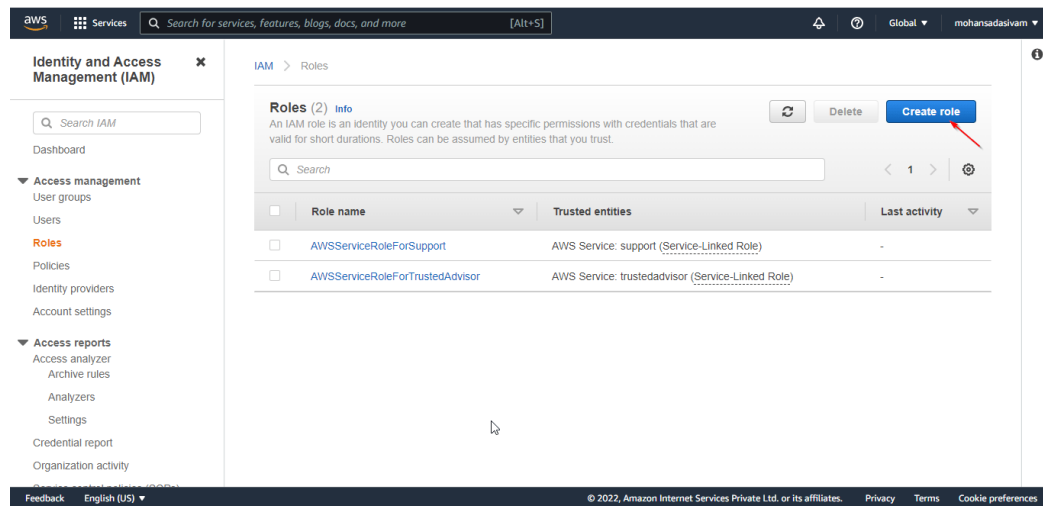
AmazonEKSClusterPolicy

Login to your AWS console and search for 'IAM'. Select the IAM service to get into IAM Console.



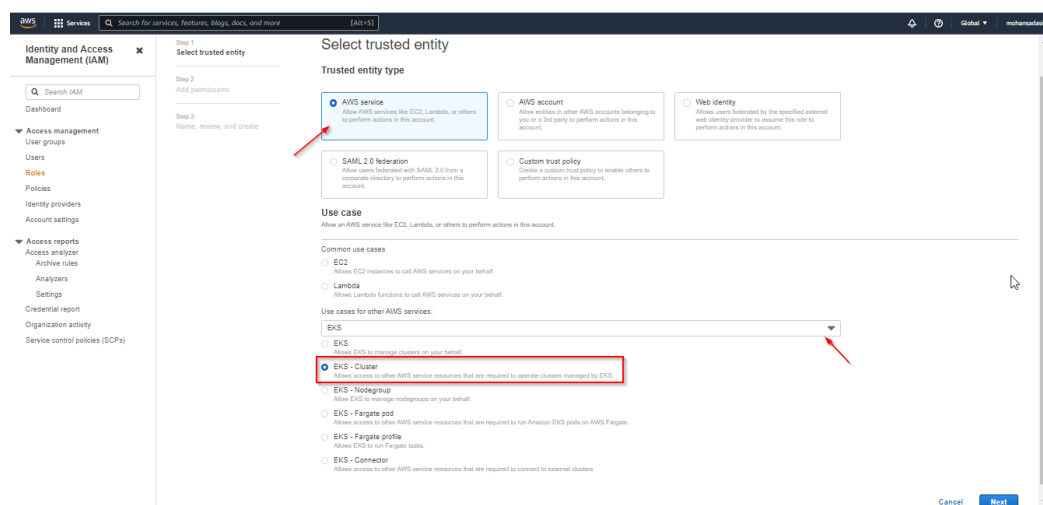
Search IAM Service

Choose Roles in the left side options and then click Create role.



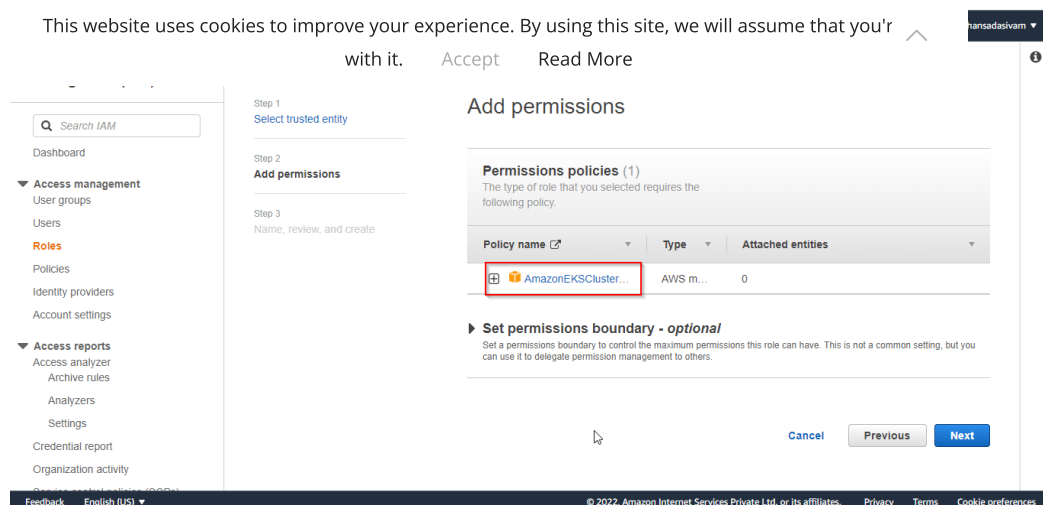
Create role

Select AWS services and select 'EKS - Cluster' in the Use cases options. Once selected, click 'Next' to proceed.



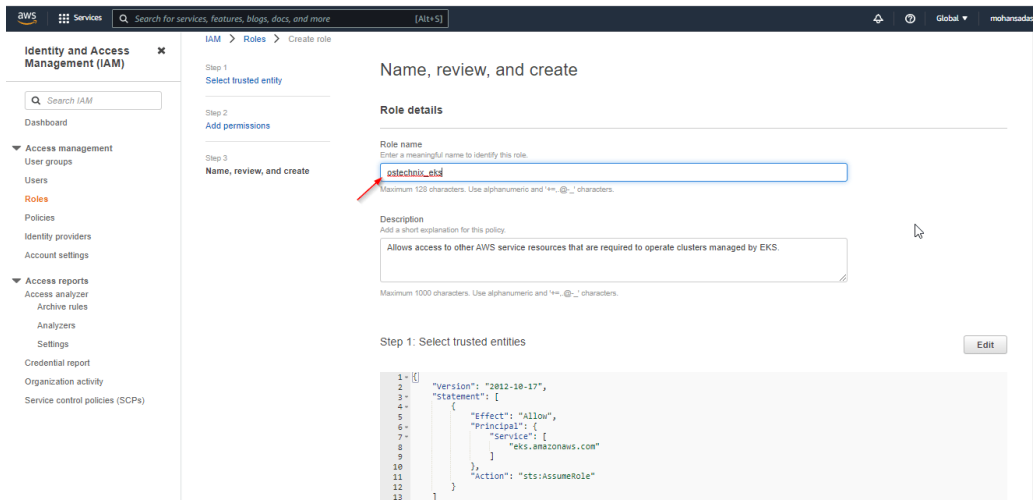
Select trusted entity for role

Make sure 'AmazonEKSClusterPolicy' is added, by default it will be added as we selected EKS-Cluster in the use cases. Click Next to proceed further.



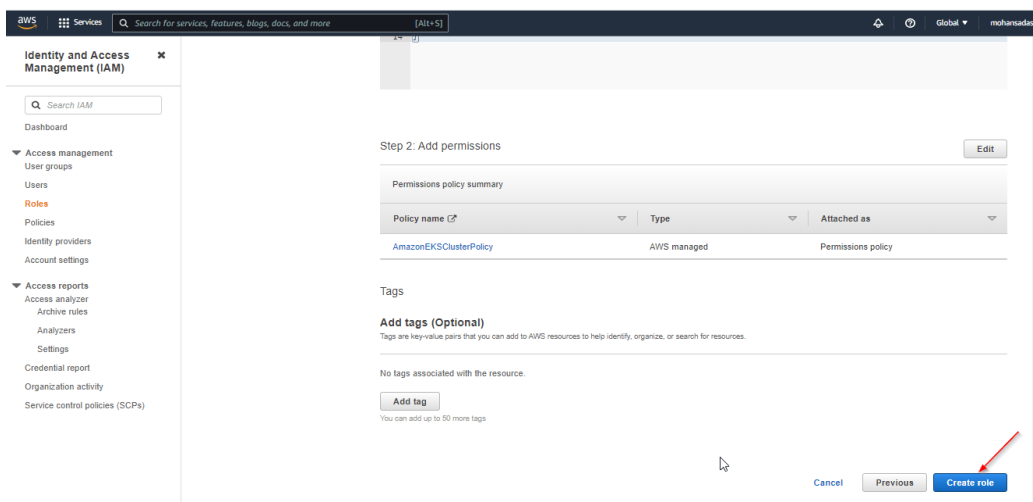
Add permission to role

In the next step, set the role name. Here, we are naming the role as 'ostechnix_eks'. Review all the parameters and click 'create' at the end to create the role.



Set role name

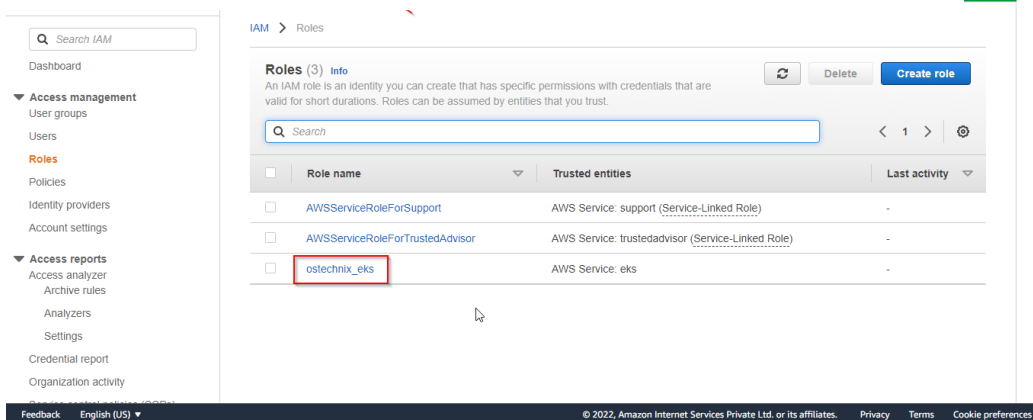
Here we don't add any tags for this role. If we are dealing with multiple resources, it will be useful having tags to manage, identify and filter resources.



Create IAM role

A new role named 'ostechnix_eks' has been just created.

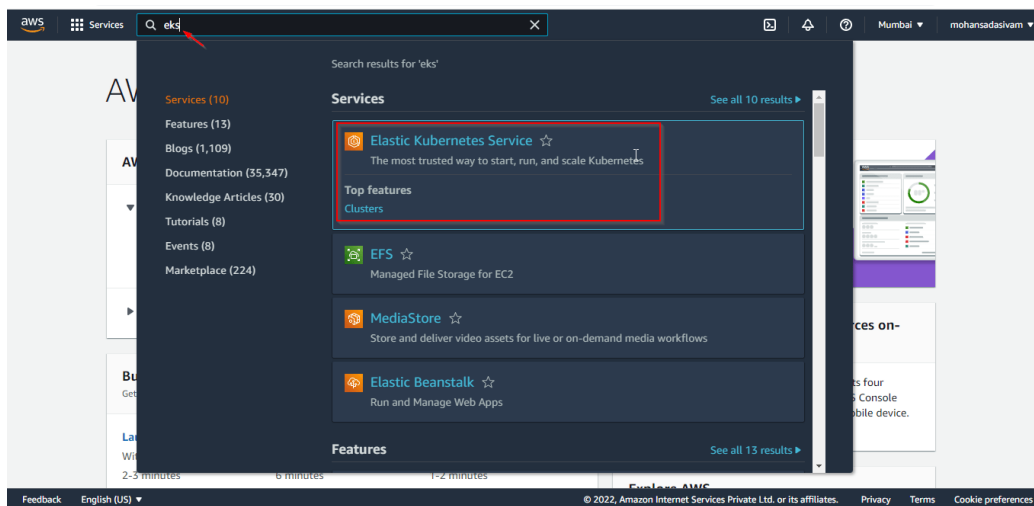
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IAM role created for EKS Cluster

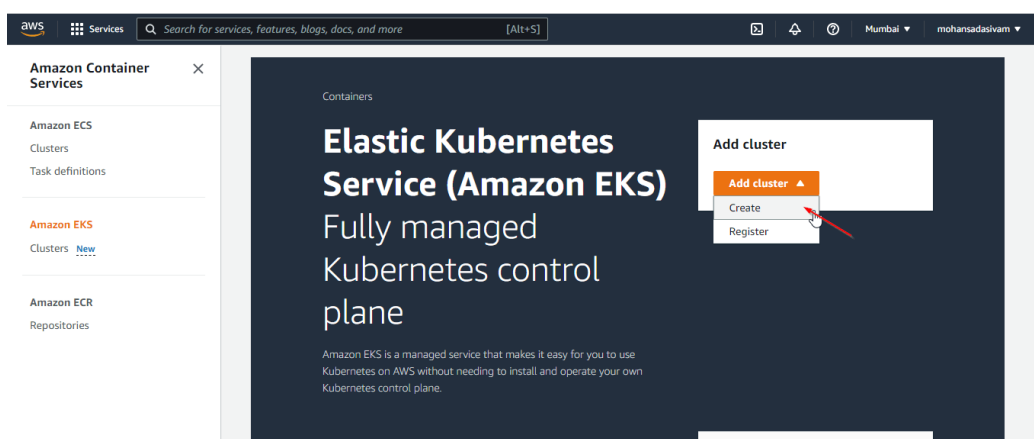
1.2. Create EKS Cluster

Go to AWS Console and search with 'EKS'. Select the 'Elastic Kubernetes Service' to get into the EKS console.



Search EKS Service

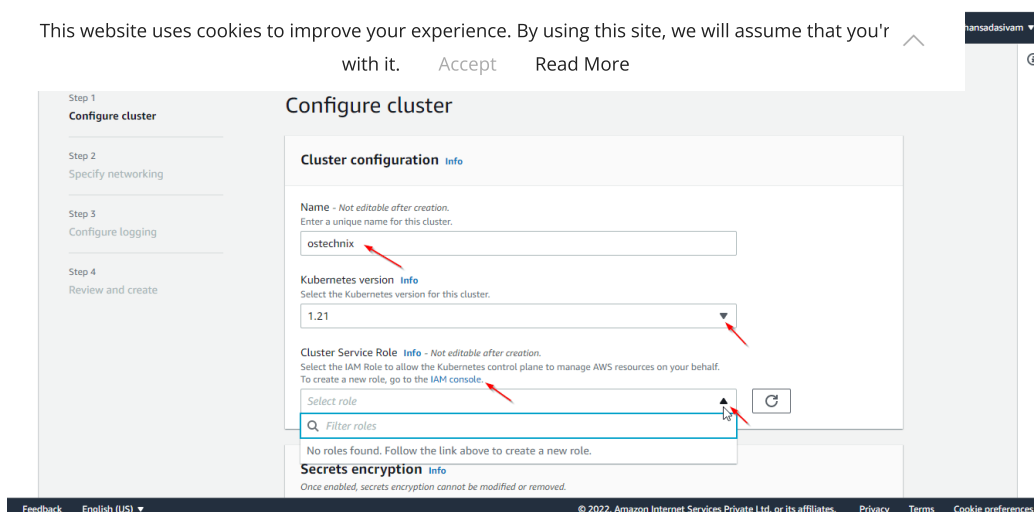
From the 'Add cluster' drop down box, choose 'create' cluster option.



Add new EKS cluster

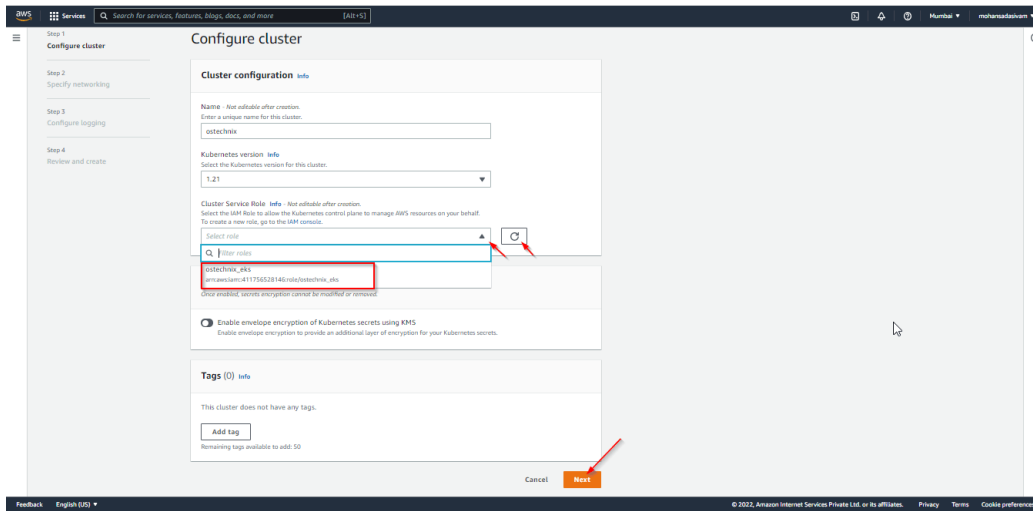
You will get the 'Configure Cluster' page where you can name the cluster, select the Kubernetes version and select the cluster service role that we created in the previous step.

Here, we named the cluster as 'ostechnix', and selected the Kubernetes version 1.21.



Configure Cluster

If you did not find the role, refresh the roles. Select the role and click 'next' to proceed.

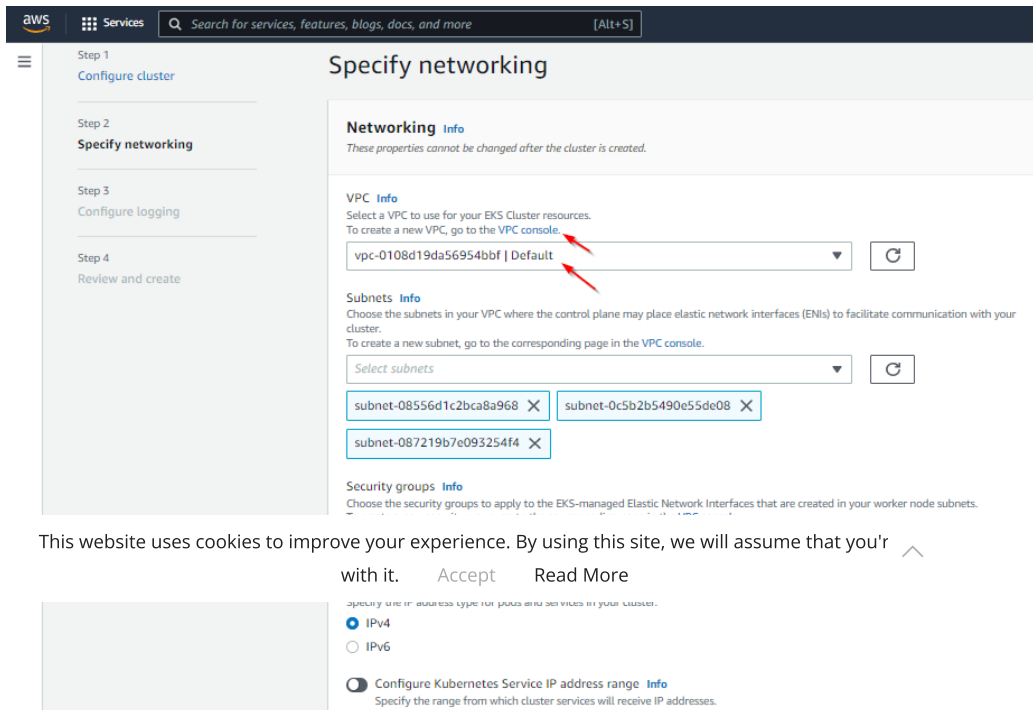


Refresh roles

In this 'Specify Networking', you need to configure the networking. Here we are proceeding with default options.

Select the existing VPC, VPC is Virtual Private Cloud where you can create AWS resources in the Virtual Network that you have defined. Proceed with the default subnets available in the default VPC.

Choose IPv4 as the Cluster IP address family. It is the default one.



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Specify networking details

Choose 'Public' for Cluster End Point access which enables only public access to your cluster. If you choose 'Private', it enables only private access to your cluster. Here, we are proceeding with Public which is the default one.

You can proceed with the default 'Networking Add-ons' and click 'Next'.

Cluster endpoint access [Info](#)
Configure access to the Kubernetes API server endpoint.

☒ **Public**
The cluster endpoint is accessible from outside of your VPC. Worker node traffic will leave your VPC to connect to the endpoint.

☐ **Public and private**
The cluster endpoint is accessible from outside of your VPC. Worker node traffic to the endpoint will stay within your VPC.

☐ **Private**
The cluster endpoint is only accessible through your VPC. Worker node traffic to the endpoint will stay within your VPC.

[Advanced Settings](#)

Networking add-ons
Configure add-ons that provide advanced networking functionalities on the cluster.

Amazon VPC CNI [Info](#)
Enable pod networking within your cluster.

Version
Select the version for this add-on.
v1.10.1-eksbuild.1

CoreDNS [Info](#)
Enable service discovery within your cluster.

Version
Select the version for this add-on.
v1.8.4-eksbuild.1

kube-proxy [Info](#)
Enable service networking within your cluster.

Version
Select the version for this add-on.
v1.21.2-eksbuild.2

Cancel Previous **Next**

Enter End Point access and Networking Add-ons details

You will get 'Configure logging' page where you can select which log types that you want to enable. By default, all the types are disabled. Click 'Next' to proceed.

Configure logging

Control Plane Logging [Info](#)
Send audit and diagnostic logs from the Amazon EKS control plane to CloudWatch Logs.

API server
Logs pertaining to API requests to the cluster.
☐ Disabled

Audit
Logs pertaining to cluster access via the Kubernetes API.
☐ Disabled

Authenticator
Logs pertaining to authentication requests into the cluster.
☐ Disabled

Controller manager
Logs pertaining to state of cluster controllers.
☐ Disabled

Scheduler
Logs pertaining to scheduling decisions.
☐ Disabled

Next

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Configure logging details

You will get 'Review and Create' page. Review all the details we configured and click 'Create' at the bottom.

Review and create

Step 1: Configure cluster [Edit](#)

Cluster configuration

Name - Not editable after creation. ostechnix	Kubernetes version 1.21
Cluster Service Role - Not editable after creation. arn:aws:iam::411756528146:role/ostechnix_eks	

Tags (0)

Filter by key or value

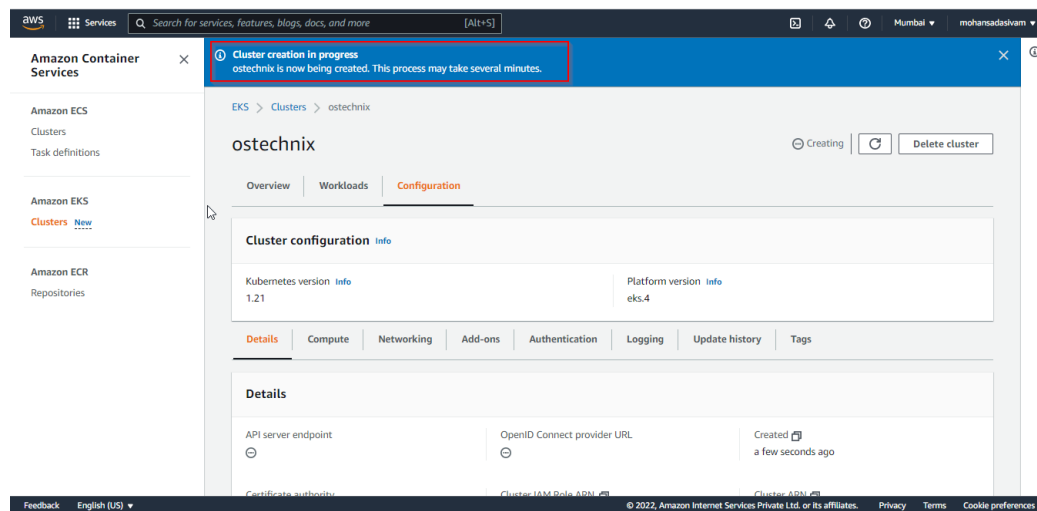
Key	Value
No tags	

This cluster does not have any tags.

Create

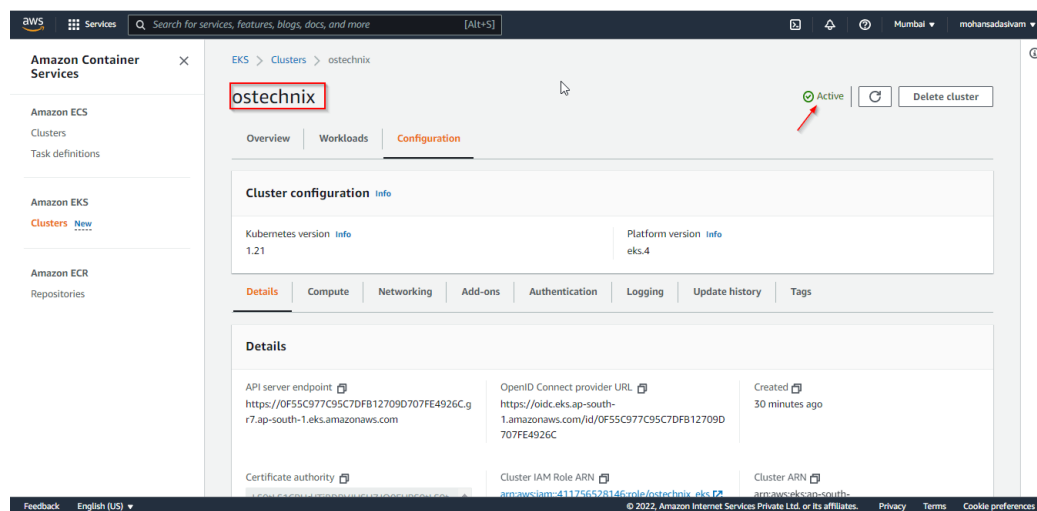
Create EKS cluster

Cluster creation will be in progress. It will take couple of minutes to get created.



EKS Cluster creation in progress

A new EKS Cluster named 'ostechnix' is created. You can verify in AWS Console?Amazon EKS?Clusters.



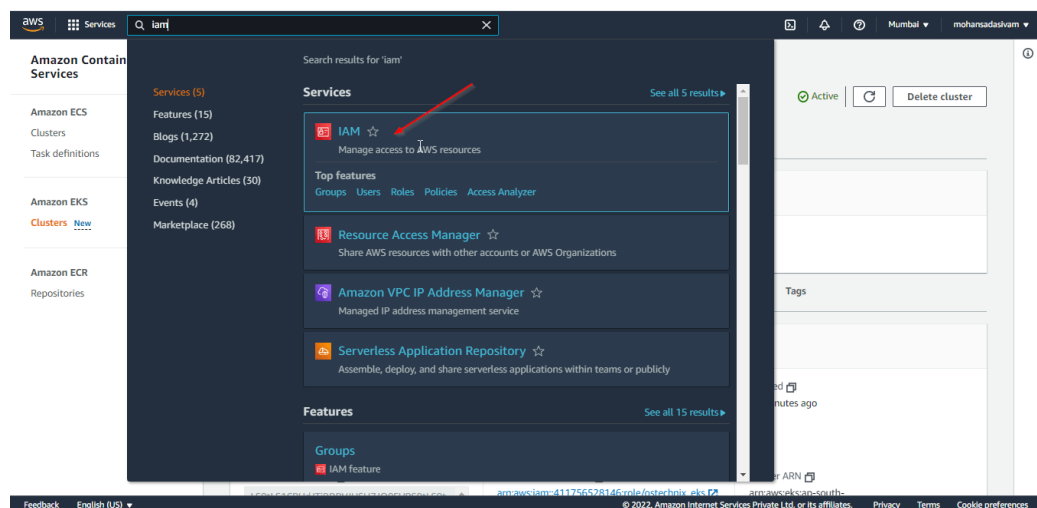
EKS Cluster state

andline.

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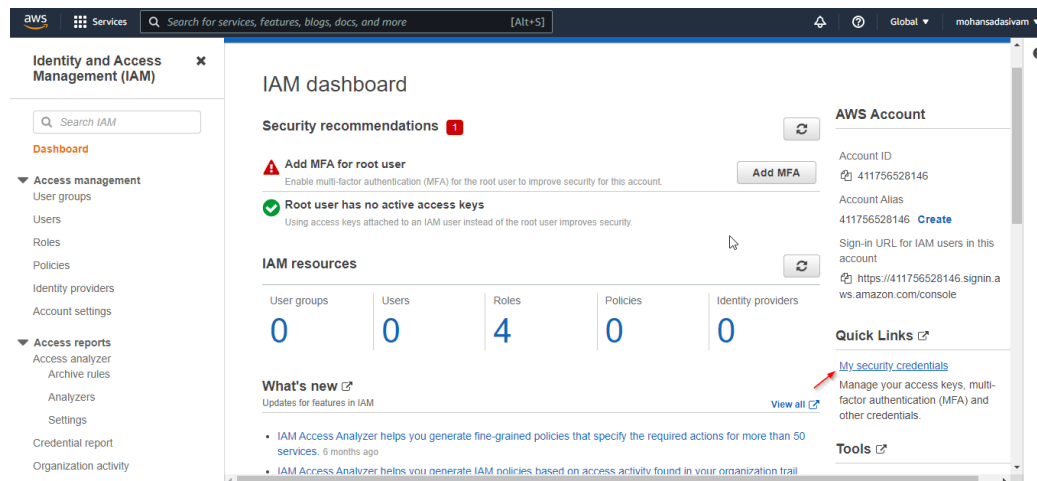
2. Create Security Credentials

Log into AWS console and search with IAM. Select IAM to get into the IAM console.



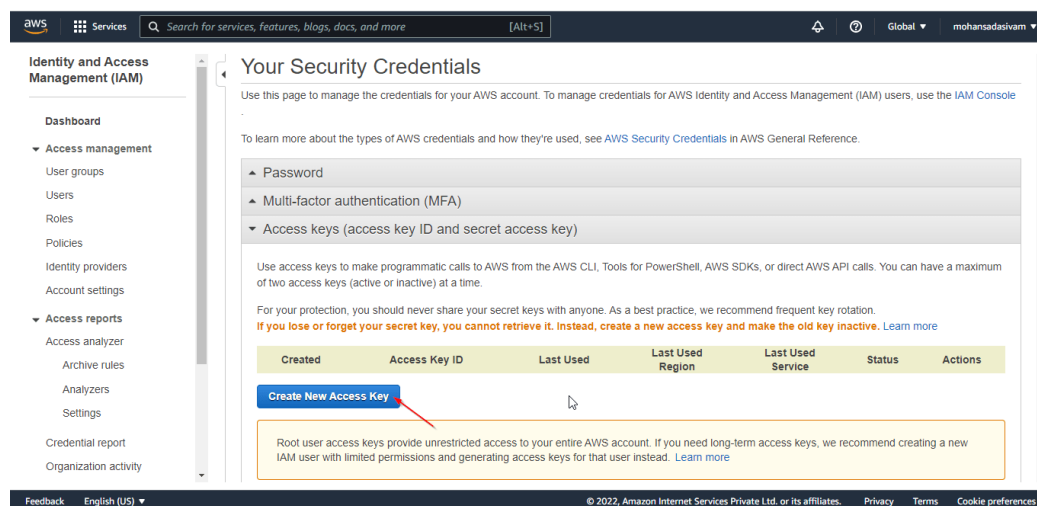
Search for IAM service

Select 'My security credentials' option available in the right to create and manage your security credentials.



Select My Security Credentials option

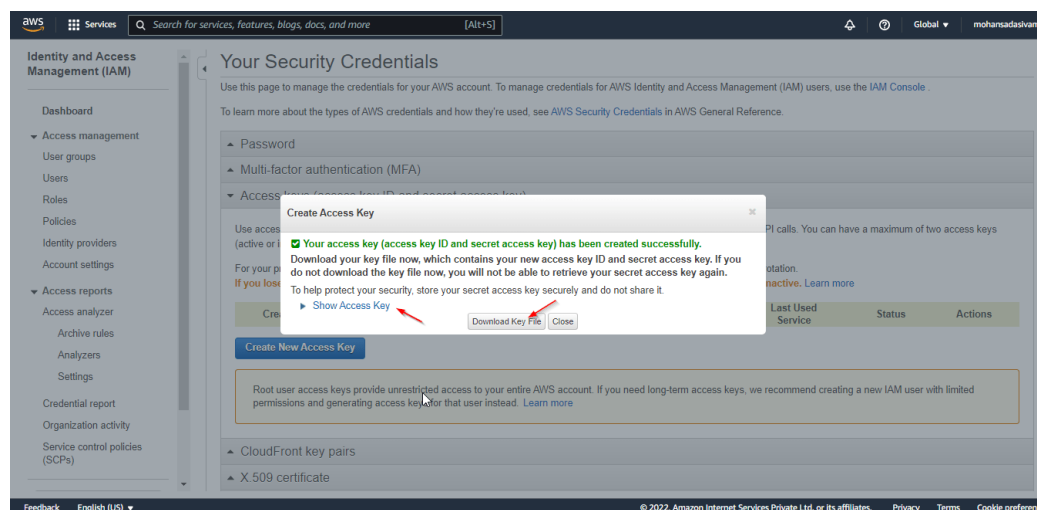
Click on 'Access Keys' drop down box and click 'Create New Access Key' option.



Create new access key

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On Linux machine, you can view the key by executing `show-access-key`.



Create Access Key

In this demonstration the key is,

- **Access Key ID:** AKIAV7XU2AIJBX4EYKUO
- **Secret Access Key:** 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

3. Install AWS CLI

AWS CLI is a command-line interface that brings all AWS services together in a single terminal, allowing you to operate numerous AWS services with a single tool.

Use the below `curl` command to download the installation file. Here, we are using 'CentOS Stream' to install and configure AWS CLI.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# curl "https://awscli.amazonaws.com/awscli-exe-linux-x86_64.
```

Unzip the installer file using the below command.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# unzip awscliv2.zip
```

Install AWS CLI using the below command.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# ./aws/install
You can now run: /usr/local/bin/aws --version
```

Verify the version using the above mentioned command.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws --version
aws-cli/2.4.17 Python/3.8.8 Linux/4.18.0-358.el8.x86_64 exe/x86_64.centos.8 pro
```

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws --version
aws-cli/2.4.17 Python/3.8.8 Linux/4.18.0-358.el8.x86_64 exe/x86_64.centos.8 prom
pt/off
[root@ostechnix ~]# █
```

Check AWS version

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Use the below command to configure the AWS CLI. It will ask for the Access Key ID and Secret Access Key that we generated in section 2.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws configure
AWS Access Key ID [None]: AKIAV7XU2AIJBX4EYKUO
AWS Secret Access Key [None]: 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
Default region name [None]:
Default output format [None]:
[root@ostechnix ~]#
```

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws configure
AWS Access Key ID [None]: AKIAV7XU2AIJBX4EYKUO
AWS Secret Access Key [None]: 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
Default region name [None]:
Default output format [None]:
[root@ostechnix ~]# █
```

Configure AWS CLI

5. Install Kubectl

Kubernetes communicates with the cluster API server via the kubectl command line utility.

Use the below curl command to download Amazon EKS vended kubectl binary from Amazon S3.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# curl -o kubectl https://amazon-eks.s3.us-west-2.amazonaws.com/1.21.2/bin/linux/amd64/kubectl
```

Add execute permission to the binary using below command.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# chmod +x ./kubectl
```

Copy this binary to the folder in your path and export the \$PATH.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# mkdir -p $HOME/bin && cp ./kubectl $HOME/bin/kubectl && export PATH=$PATH:$HOME/bin
```

Export the PATH to ~/.bashrc:

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# echo 'export PATH=$PATH:$HOME/bin' >> ~/.bashrc
```

Kubectl is installed, you can verify the version using the below command.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# kubectl version --short --client
Client Version: v1.21.2-13+d2965f0db10712
```

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# kubectl version --short --client
Client Version: v1.21.2-13+d2965f0db10712
[root@ostechnix ~]#
```

Check Kubectl version

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Right now kubectl does not know where the EKS Master node is located in AWS. We need to let kubectl know where the Master server is located by mentioning the **region** name and **cluster** name.

Use the below command to check the status of the EKS Cluster.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws eks --region ap-south-1 describe-cluster --name ostechnix
{"name": "ostechnix", "status": "ACTIVE"}
```

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws eks --region ap-south-1 describe-cluster --name ostechnix --query cluster.status
"ACTIVE"
[root@ostechnix ~]#
```

Check EKS Cluster status

Update the kubeconfig file to use kubectl to interact with the EKS cluster. It will fetch all the configurations from Master node to kubeconfig file.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# /usr/local/bin/aws eks --region ap-south-1 update-kubeconfig
Added new context arn:aws:eks:ap-south-1:411756528146:cluster/ostechnix to /root/.aws/config
```

Verify the kubectl by checking the service using the below command. You can ensure the Kubectl is able to connect with the EKS cluster.

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# kubectl get svc
NAME          TYPE          CLUSTER-IP    EXTERNAL-IP    PORT(S)    AGE
kubernetes    ClusterIP     10.100.0.1    <none>         443/TCP    105m
```

```
[root@ostechnix ~]# kubectl get svc
NAME          TYPE          CLUSTER-IP    EXTERNAL-IP    PORT(S)    AGE
kubernetes    ClusterIP     10.100.0.1    <none>         443/TCP    105m
[root@ostechnix ~]#
```

Get service details with kubectl command

Conclusion

In this article, we have learned how to **provision Amazon EKS cluster** and how to **setup AWS CLI and Kubectl for the EKS cluster** in Linux platform.

I've successfully deployed Kubernetes cluster on AWS cloud, now what? You might wonder. Please check our next guide to know how to add Node Groups and configure the worker nodes in AWS EKS cluster.

- [How To Add Worker Nodes To Amazon EKS Cluster](#)

Resource:

- <https://docs.aws.amazon.com/eks/latest/userguide/create-cluster.html>



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